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MAR 2025

PROSCI CATALYST REPORT

Research Insights for Change Success

Evaluating AI Success

Metrics that Differentiate Successful AI Implementations

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Executive Summary

Recent Prosci research analyzing AI implementation across 1,107 participants—including 193 executives, 389 team leaders, and 525 frontline workers—reveals critical patterns in how organizations evaluate AI success.

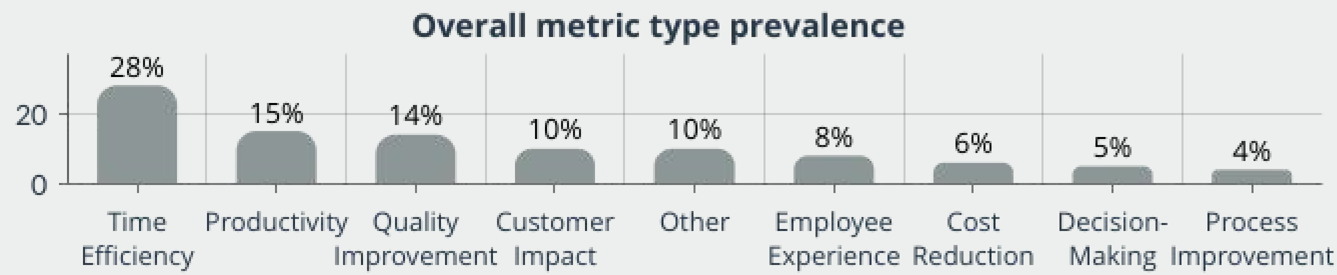
Our analysis shows that organizations with positive business outcomes are **6.3 percentage points more likely to measure productivity gains** and **6.9 percentage points more likely to track quality improvements.** Successful implementers use **2.3 different metric types** on average, compared to just 1.8 for struggling organizations, creating a more comprehensive view of AI's impact.

While time efficiency metrics remain the most common evaluation approach across all organizations (28%), **successful implementations demonstrate a more balanced and multidimensional evaluation framework.** They are 5.6 percentage points more likely to measure employee experience impacts, 5.3 percentage points more likely to track time efficiency, and 4.6 percentage points more likely to evaluate productivity enhancements.

This report details these differences and provides a practical framework for developing evaluation metrics that drive AI adoption success.

Research Methodology

Based on 1,107 survey responses across organizations implementing AI (including 193 executives, 389 team leaders, and 525 individual contributors), this report explores AI evaluation from two primary perspectives. From the first perspective, we explore results across all respondents, revealing the most common types of AI metrics.



For the second perspective, we developed a composite success score to classify organizations in the top quartile (n=365, 32.9%) as "Successful Implementations" and those in the bottom quartile (n=567, 51.2%) as "Struggling Implementations." From this second perspective, we can explore the AI evaluation approaches and characteristics that distinguish successful AI implementations.

Successful implementations consistently outpace struggling ones in their use of time efficiency metrics (41% vs. 36%), quality improvement measures (24% vs. 17%), and employee experience (10% vs. 4%) — suggesting measurement approach is a key differentiator of AI success. This report explores these findings and more in greater detail.

Note: Percentage comparisons are presented independently and may not sum to 100%.

What to Evaluate in AI Implementation

Below are the primary types of metrics used in evaluating AI implementation along with their relative frequency, definition, and representative quotes from study participants:

Category	%	Definition	In participants' words...
Time Efficiency	28%	Focus on efficiency, speed, and productivity improvements	▪ "If I get done faster" - Individual, Professional, Scientific & Technical Services ▪ "When we see something being accomplished quicker than if it was done in our prior ways" - Manager, Government - Federal
Productivity	15%	Focus on increased output volume or production	▪ "We have a growth in productivity" - Manager, Information Services ▪ "By having increased productivity which increases revenue" - Executive, Professional, Scientific & Technical Services
Quality Improvement	14%	Focus on accuracy, error reduction, and improvement	▪ "If work is being done correctly and quicker" - Manager, Manufacturing ▪ "The work quality is getting better" - Individual, Real Estate & Rental & Leasing
Customer Impact	10%	Focus on customer satisfaction and experience	▪ "We know if it's helping based off the feedback we get from consumers and employees" - Executive, Retail Trade ▪ "We have seen a significant rise in overall satisfaction from our clients" - Manager, Finance
Employee Experience	8%	Focus on staff satisfaction, morale, and team performance	▪ "If productivity and morale is up then we know it's working for sure" - Executive, Transportation & Warehousing ▪ "Team members are less stressed and more engaged with their primary responsibilities" - Manager, Education Services
Cost Reduction	6%	Focus on financial savings, ROI, and resource optimization	▪ "I look at how much is getting done and things like ROI or metrics such as time on task and outputs" - Manager, Information Services ▪ "It leads to higher employee effectiveness, cost saving" - Individual, Manufacturing
Decision-Making	5%	Focus on improved insights, data analysis, and information quality	▪ "AI helps by freeing my time for more strategic thinking" - Individual, Information Services ▪ "Performance reviews, management tracking data" - Individual, Government - Federal
Process Improvement	4%	Focus on workflow enhancement and operational efficiency	▪ "Our workflows are much smoother now" - Manager, Manufacturing ▪ "Processes that used to take multiple steps now happen automatically" - Individual, Finance
Other	10%	Various context-specific evaluation approaches	▪ "I know it is working because it consistently helps us achieve our goals" - Executive, Health Care ▪ "When I see the positive changes in our operations" - Manager, Construction

Specific AI Metrics by Category

Below are specific metrics derived from participant responses that organizations can use to evaluate AI implementation success within each measurement category:

Time Efficiency (28%)

Metric	Description	In participants' words...
Task Completion Time	Time to finish specific tasks	"Tasks being accomplished quicker than in our prior ways"
Process Cycle Time	End-to-end duration for processes	"Projects completed within weeks instead of months"
Response Time	Speed of responses to requests	"Information comes through quicker than before"
Meeting Duration	Length of meetings	"Employee meetings shortened, saving time on tasks"

Productivity (15%)

Metric	Description	In participants' words...
Output Volume	Quantity of work produced	"A lot more work gets done efficiently"
Task Completion Rate	Tasks finished per time period	"We have a growth in productivity"
Revenue per Employee	Financial output per person	"Increased productivity which increases revenue"
Throughput	Volume processed through system	"Processing more orders than ever before"

Quality Improvement (14%)

Metric	Description	In participants' words...
Error Rate	Frequency of mistakes	"Tasks done with less errors"
Revision Frequency	Need for corrections	"The work quality is getting better"
Compliance Rate	Adherence to standards	"Regulatory compliance improved significantly"
Consistency	Uniformity of outputs	"Work is being done correctly and quicker"

Customer Impact (10%)

Metric	Description	In participants' words...
Satisfaction Score	Customer happiness	"We have seen a significant rise in overall satisfaction"
Net Promoter Score	Likelihood to recommend	"We know by feedback we get from consumers"
Retention Rate	Customers who stay	"We've gained more clients from even existing customers"
Resolution Time	Time to solve issues	"Support issues resolved faster with AI assistance"

Specific AI Metrics by Category

Below are specific metrics derived from participant responses that organizations can use to evaluate AI implementation success within each measurement category:

Employee Experience (8%)

Metric	Description	In participants' words...
Satisfaction	Content with work experience	"Team members are less stressed and more engaged"
Stress Levels	Work-related stress	"If productivity and morale is up then we know it's working"
Engagement	Involvement and enthusiasm	"Employees seem to be happier and more productive"
Focus Time	Uninterrupted productive work	"More time away from computer focusing on priorities"

Cost Reduction (6%)

Metric	Description	In participants' words...
Labor Cost Savings	Personnel expense reduction	"No need to pay for overtime to crunch numbers"
ROI	Return on investment	"Positive results and a return on our investment"
Operational Costs	Ongoing expense changes	"It leads to higher employee effectiveness, cost saving"
Resource Optimization	Efficient resource use	"All processes are optimized well"

Decision-Making (5%)

Metric	Description	In participants' words...
Decision Cycle	Time to reach decisions	"Faster decision-making across the organization"
Data Utilization	Data-informed decisions	"AI [offers] data analysis and insights for informed decisions"
Strategic Success	Outcomes of decisions	"AI helps by freeing my time for more strategic thinking"
Forecast Accuracy	Prediction precision	"Data analytics team generates actionable insights faster"

Process Improvement (4%)

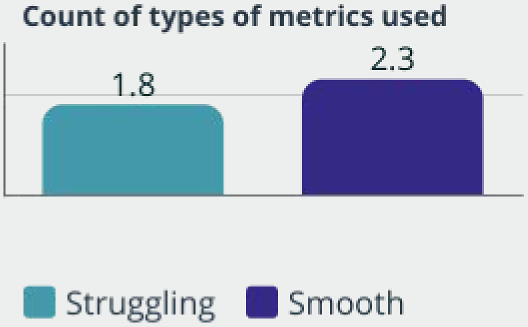
Metric	Description	In participants' words...
Workflow Efficiency	Process streamlining	"Our workflows are much smoother now"
Automation Rate	Process steps automated	"Automation of tasks that used to be manual in nature"
Process Consistency	Reliability of execution	"We know by noticing difference in ease and efficiency"
Handoff Reduction	Work transfers between parties	"Processes that used to take multiple steps now happen automatically"

Building Your AI Evaluation Strategy

Comprehensive Measurement Approaches

Organizations with successful AI implementations demonstrate a more comprehensive approach to evaluation, integrating multiple metric types—such as time efficiency, quality improvements, customer satisfaction, and employee experience—rather than relying on a single dimension of measurement. This multifaceted approach provides a more complete picture of AI's impact across the organization.

- Successful implementers use **2.3 distinct metric categories** compared to just 1.8 for struggling implementations
- **Multi-level measurement approaches** span individual, team, and organizational impacts
- **Balanced scorecard approaches** integrate technical, business, and human factors



Governance and Accountability

The research reveals significant differences in how evaluation processes are structured and governed, with successful AI implementations showing:

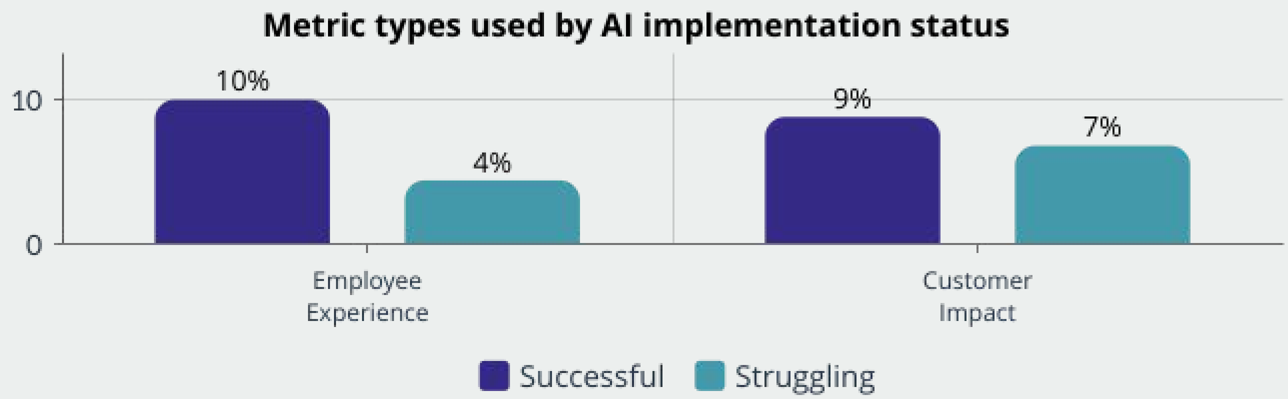
- **Clear ownership of measurement** with defined roles and responsibilities
- **Regular cadence of evaluation** rather than one-time assessments
- **Transparent sharing of results** across organizational levels

"We track specific KPIs, such as increased productivity, reduced time for task completion, and improved accuracy in outputs. If we see consistent improvements in these metrics after implementing AI, it's a strong indicator of success."

Study Participant, Team Leader

Evaluating the Human Experience of AI

Successful AI implementations are consistently more likely to incorporate metrics focusing on human experience and engagement:



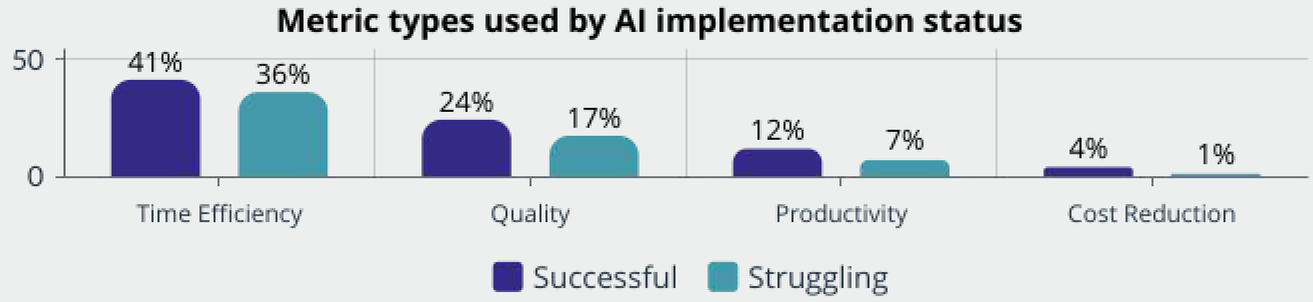
- Employee experience metrics are **5.6 percentage points** more common in successful implementations
- Customer impact measurements are **2.0 percentage points** more prevalent in successful organizations

"I know [AI] is helping my team because we have more time away from the computer and focusing on other priorities."

Study Participant, Team Leader in the Accommodation & Food Services Industry

Evaluating AI Efficiency & Performance

While both successful and struggling implementations utilize metrics to evaluate AI, their approach differs significantly in scope and application:



Time-Based Efficiency Metrics

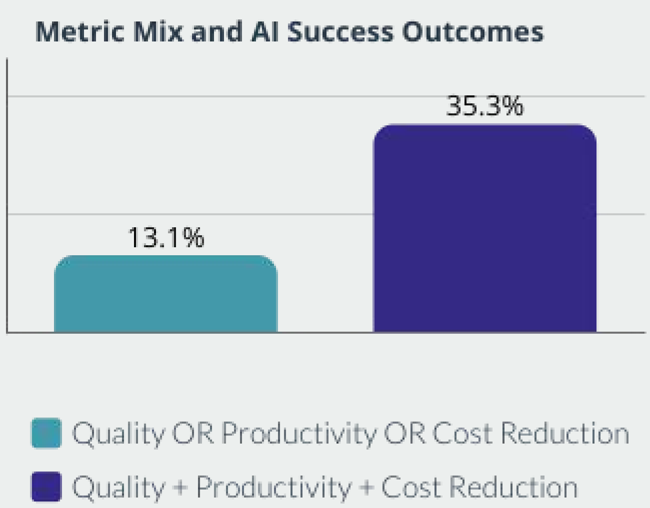
Time efficiency remains the most cited metric across organizations, with successful AI implementations using it **5.3 percentage points** more often than struggling ones. The key difference: successful organizations consider time savings within overall process improvements and establish clear before/after baselines to accurately measure impact.

Outcome-Based Performance Metrics

Successful AI implementations track quality improvements **6.9 percentage points** more frequently, productivity gains **4.6 percentage points** more often, and cost reductions **2.8 percentage points** more commonly than struggling organizations. Successful implementers' focus on measuring business results across multiple dimensions.

The Multiplier Effect of AI Evaluation

Organizations that evaluate quality, productivity, and cost reduction in their AI implementation have a 35.3% successful implementation rate—**2.7 times higher** than those measuring only one of these dimensions (13.1%). This finding shows that a comprehensive AI measurement mix isn't just good practice—it's a critical factor that directly impacts the likelihood of AI implementation success.



Role-Specific Evaluation Approaches

When implementing AI, all roles are not created equal. Our research shows that successful implementations tailor evaluation metrics to different organizational roles:

Metric Categories	Definition	Executives	Team Leaders	Individual Contributors
Efficiency Metrics	Time savings, faster completion	44%	38%	29%
Strategic/Business Outcomes	Revenue, market position impact	37%	25%	14%
Quality Improvement	Accuracy, fewer errors	20%	17%	15%
Creativity & Innovation	New ideas, better solutions	15%	15%	27%
Team Coordination	Workflow, collective performance	8%	14%	10%
Process Information	Data handling, information flow	6%	8%	11%

This data demonstrates clear differences in evaluation priorities:

- **Executives** focus 2.6x more on strategic outcomes (37%) than individual contributors (14%)
- **Team leaders** prioritize team coordination (14%) at nearly twice the rate of executives (8%)
- **Individual contributors** prioritize creativity and innovation metrics (27%) at almost double the rate of executives (15%)

These differences highlight the importance of creating role-aligned evaluation frameworks that address each group's specific AI priorities, perspectives, and concerns.

Moving Forward

The Path to Successful AI Implementation

The ROI of Taking Action: Why Evaluation Frameworks Matter

Our research highlights the vital benefits of a strong AI evaluation framework, emphasizing their importance from the start of your AI implementation.

- Organizations with comprehensive evaluation approaches are **1.3x more likely** to report positive business outcomes
- Successful implementers use **2.3 different metric types** per response versus just 1.8 for struggling organizations
- Organizations that evaluate quality, productivity, and cost reduction have a 35.3% successful implementation rate—**2.7x higher** than those measuring only one dimension (13.1%)

Building an Effective AI Evaluation Framework

Based on these findings, organizations should focus AI implementation evaluation on:

- **Strategic Integration:** Use multi-dimensional metrics, balance outcome-based and experience-based measures, and set clear baselines before implementation.
- **Human-Centered Focus:** Prioritize employee experience, including feedback channels and observational assessments.
- **Continuous Learning:** Conduct regular evaluations, share results transparently, and refine implementation based on insights.
- **Role-Aligned Metrics:** Customize metrics by role, link individual work to organizational outcomes, and evaluate both technical and human factors.

Partnering for **Change Done Right**
The Prosci Advantage

This research underscores both the transformative potential of AI and the critical importance of navigating the human side of implementation to realize that potential. While many organizations provide change management as an add-on to their implementation, at Prosci, getting change done right is our purpose and passion. That's why Prosci is uniquely positioned to help you on this journey. As a global leader in change management, Prosci offers:

- Best practices and proven methodologies from years of research and experience
- Deep expertise in the people side of change and technology adoption
- Customized solutions to address your unique adoption goals and challenges
- A track record of driving successful transformation in organizations around the world

By partnering with Prosci, you gain access to the expert guidance and proven strategies needed to proactively address the human side of AI and position your organization for transformative success.

Are you ready to elevate your AI initiative, achieve game-changing AI adoption, and drive business outcomes that achieve your vision? Contact Prosci today to explore how our proven methodologies and expertise can empower your organization to realize the full value of AI.

To learn more, visit https://www.prosci.com/ai-change-management or email solutions@prosci.com to schedule a free consultation. Together, we can help you deliver AI transformation done right.